



A new home: Marcus Rashford made a year-long loan move from Manchester United to FC Barcelona. GETTY IMAGES

signing of Matheus Cunha from Wolves. United began its pre-season with a 0-0 draw against newly promoted Leeds United before beating West Ham United 2-1 in the Premier League Summer Series.

Speaking of United, Marcus Rashford has followed Englishman Gary Lineker's footsteps by making a year-long loan move to FC Barcelona. Four days after the announcement, he made his debut for the club in its 3-1 win against Vissel Kobe.

Messi leads the charge

It took a gritty defensive performance from FC Cincinnati to end Lionel Messi's **(right)** record five-game streak with two or more goals in Major League Soccer and pull off a 3-0 win. Cincinnati managed to keep the Argentine maestro at bay, with Miami managing only two shots on target throughout the game. At the other end, a brace from Evander and a tidy finish from 20-year-old Gerardo Valenzuela helped their side clinch top spot in the Eastern Conference.

Messi bounced back quickly from

the poor showing, producing two goals and two assists against New York Red Bulls in the following game.

The brace took Messi's tally to 18 goals in the league this season, tying him for the Golden Boot with Nashville SC's Sam Surridge.

However, he and Jordi Alba missed Miami's next match against Cincinnati due to a one-match ban handed out by the MLS.

The decision by the league, which, according to Inter Miami owner Jorge Mas, made Messi "extremely upset", followed the duo's absence from the MLS All-Star Game.

The gaps left by the two were evident as Miami failed to find a breakthrough against Cincinnati, playing out a 0-0 draw. The team currently sits fifth in the Eastern Conference standings with 42 points from 22 games — eight points behind leader Philadelphia Union, which has played three extra games.

(All results updated as of July 29)



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